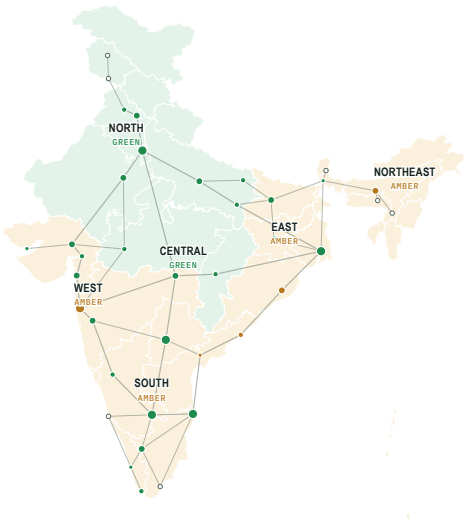
INB INDIA NETWORK BULLETIN · EDITION 021 TUESDAY 27 OCTOBER 2026 · 09:00 IST

Arnab cancels 53 trains before landfall near Yanam

NETWORK: AMBER

Cyclone Arnab, now a very severe storm, is due ashore near Yanam, a sliver of Puducherry on the Andhra coast, by Wednesday forenoon[1,2]. South Coast Railway has already cancelled 53 trains through the Godavari delta for Tuesday and Wednesday[3], and the ports from Visakhapatnam to Kakinada sit in its path. On the west coast, BPCL is buying less Russian crude for November, because the tanker freight costs too much[4].

HOW'S EACH REGION HOLDING UP?



Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

DATES TO WATCH

27–28 Oct	53 trains cancelled through coastal Andhra
27 Oct–5 Nov	NH-10 night closures into Sikkim
Wed 28 Oct	Arnab crosses the coast near Yanam
28–30 Oct	Heavy rain in south Bengal
29–30 Oct	Central team in Karnataka on cane prices
Sun 1 Nov	Delhi admits only BS-VI or cleaner outside goods vehicles
Sun 1 Nov	Connecting Link closed to goods vehicles for good

GREEN freight running normally, which in a sale or festival week can still be busy

AMBER something is slowing freight, new or one that comes every year

RED something is stopping freight across a state or a route

North

GREEN

Nothing reported on the northern highways or freight lines slows cargo this morning, so no delay beyond the season.

West

AMBER

Boxes for inland depots at JNPA climbed by 203 TEU on Monday, to 3,507[5,6]. DP World now runs double-stack trains from JNPA to its depots in the NCR and Ahmedabad, over the dedicated freight corridor[7]. I'd expect those trains to pull the queue back under 3,500 by Friday, so a box for Delhi or Gujarat waits a day or two at the port, not a week. Goods vehicles stay off the Mumbai–Pune Expressway's new Connecting Link for good from Sunday, so trucks keep to the slower old ghat road[8].

South

AMBER

IMD's red warning for extremely heavy rain covers Kakinada, Konaseema, both Godavari districts and Eluru today, and Visakhapatnam down to Guntur tomorrow[1]. Andhra stops traffic on its coastal roads from this afternoon, Rediff reports[2], so trucks for the coast wait inland. My estimate: freight for Rajahmundry, Kakinada and Eluru sits in Vijayawada's sheds till Thursday, and reaches those towns over the weekend. In Karnataka, the cane farmers wait for a central team on the 29th and 30th[9], so their highway blockades can return without notice.

East

AMBER

Odisha has named six southern districts, Ganjam, Gajapati, Rayagada, Malkangiri, Koraput and Nabarangpur, as vulnerable to Arnab[3]. My estimate is that freight for the hill districts, Koraput to Malkangiri, is held two days from Wednesday, with Kalinga ghat already shut on the road from Berhampur to Phulbani.

Northeast

AMBER

Some 300 coke trucks have now waited 40 days at Srirampur, on NH-27, the main road out of the Northeast. Their owners have asked the Finance Ministry and the customs board to release them, The Times of India reports[10]. Their demurrage is about ₹1 crore (about $115,000). I'd expect the trucks to be still there on Sunday, with nobody yet saying why they are held.

Central

GREEN

Raipur and Indore move their usual late-October freight, and no report shows a hold-up, so no delay beyond the season.

NETWORK INSIGHTS

1 IMD expects 14-metre waves off three Andhra ports on Wednesday

Visakhapatnam, Gangavaram and Kakinada ports; the Howrah–Chennai line and NH-16 through the Godavari delta

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

IMD's impact assessment puts waves at 14 metres or more off the Andhra and Yanam coast by Wednesday morning, with landfall close to Yanam that forenoon, says Inchcape, a shipping agent[11]. It tells ship operators to take care with pilotage and berthing, and expects conditions to improve from Thursday. South Coast Railway has cancelled 53 trains for Tuesday and Wednesday as a precaution, Kakinada Port's line to Rajahmundry among them[12]. No port had announced a halt by this morning. Does that mean berthing goes on? Not in seas like that, I'd think. I'd expect Visakhapatnam, Gangavaram and Kakinada to lose Wednesday's berthing and most of Thursday's, and the ships held offshore to take the weekend to clear, as they all come in at once.

> **The east coast corridor between Kolkata and Chennai, rail and NH-16 alike, runs about two days late through the Godavari delta, and three ports' ship calls slip into the weekend.**

2 BPCL buys less Russian crude for November because tanker freight costs too much

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

Bharat Petroleum will take far fewer Russian cargoes in November, because higher freight costs make Middle Eastern crude the better buy, its head of finance told analysts on Monday, Baird Maritime reports[4]. Russian crude was about 37% of its mix last quarter. BPCL also plans a 30-day shutdown of some units at its Mumbai refinery, and a 30 to 40 day turnaround at Kochi. Is that a big shift for the ports? For the tankers, actually, it is: fewer long Russian voyages, more Gulf ones. I'd expect fewer crude tankers into Mumbai and Kochi in November, while those units are down.

> **Mumbai's and Kochi's crude berths take fewer tankers in November, and each Gulf cargo that replaces a Russian one costs less to ship. The shutdowns, not the war, set the month's crude calls.**

THE LANES I'M WATCHING

NH-157 Kalinga ghat

AMBER

SHUT A MONTH AFTER LANDSLIDES; A 50 KM DETOUR

A month after the landslides, Kalinga ghat on NH-157, between Ganjam and Kandhamal in Odisha, is still closed, and goods carriers take a detour of about 50 km, The New Indian Express reports[13]. IIT Delhi's experts inspected it on Sunday, but there is no reopening date yet, it seems. I'd expect Phulbani's supplies to keep costing more to truck in, and Arnab's rain on the same hills from Wednesday to push any reopening past next week.

PORTS AND CITY ROADS, MEASURED

JNPA truck turnaround, hours[5]



1.7 h on 26 Oct

Paradip cargo, thousand tonnes a day[14]



448 against 384 on 25 Oct

City roads against usual on 26 Oct[15] amber = 10+ over

Delhi **+9** Mumbai **+9** Pune **+8** Ahmedabad **+6** Chennai **+6** Hyderabad **+4** Jaipur **+4** Kochi **+1** Bengaluru **+0** Kolkata **-3**

HOW MY CALLS HAVE DONE

Of the 8 calls scored so far, 6 came true, 1 partly and 1 didn't. 4 are still open. From 19 Oct:

1. Kolkata's roads run 10 or more points over usual on at least three of the five immersion days, 20th–24th October. **Wrong.** Kolkata ran 6 to 23 points below usual by day on all five, by TomTom's hourly readings. Source
2. IMD reports a low over the southeast Bay of Bengal by 26th October (Monday). **Right.** IMD reported a depression over the Bay on the 24th, two days early. Source
3. JNPA's import boxes waiting for trains are still above 3,000 TEU in its report of 25th October. **Right.** 3,304 TEU waited for inland trains on the 25th. Source

HOW THIS IS MADE

At 7 every morning, Claude drafts this page on its own using data available from public sources only. It reads the morning's public signals: city traffic in ten cities, the JNPA and Paradip port reports, ship queues at the container ports, toll-plaza truck counts, the seasonal calendar and about twenty news searches.

Then it writes, and a set of checks decides whether the draft is even fit for me to read. Every claim has to be opened and cited, and no source can be over a week old without a reason. No story from the last seven days comes back unless it actually moved, and nothing gets said twice.

I read it, argue with it, fix what's wrong and approve it. The ratings are my judgement on the likelihood of on-time delivery or cost-impact, not measured service levels or actual cost estimates. Confidence is High when the facts are dated and primary or measured, Medium when they rest on a proxy or a forecast. Does that make the page right? Not always, which is why the calls get scored.

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SOURCES

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2. Rediff: Arnab now a very severe storm, 27 Oct
3. India Today: 53 trains cancelled, four states on alert, 26 Oct
4. Baird Maritime: tanker rates cut BPCL's Russian oil, 26 Oct
5. JNPA daily status report, 26 Oct
6. JNPA daily status report, 25 Oct
7. BusinessLine: DP World double-stack trains from JNPA, 26 Oct
8. Times of India: goods vehicles stay off the Connecting Link, 26 Oct
9. Deccan Herald: CM seeks more time on cane price, 26 Oct
10. Times of India: coke trucks stranded at Assam–Bengal border, 26 Oct
11. Inchcape Shipping: Arnab advisory for Andhra and Odisha, 26 Oct
12. Telugu360: 53 trains cancelled in AP, 26 Oct
13. New Indian Express: Kalinga ghat inspected, 26 Oct
14. Paradip Port daily traffic report, 25 Oct
15. TomTom Traffic Index, ten cities